Standard Operating Procedure (SOP)

Country Specific Requirements Kazakhstan, Kyrgyzstan, Mongolia (CH), Uzbekistan (CH)

Document Number: IQMS-70773
SSC-PTC-SOP-KZ-006

Version: 4.0

Effective Date:	2025-05-26
QMS Area:	Quality
QMS Chapter:	4.9 Product Safety, Product Quality and Pharmacovigilance

Applicability

Bayer Level:	CH, PH

This document is electronically approved (signatures on the last page)

Distribution Sheet for Quality Regulations

Division/Business Unit	☒ PH ☒ CH
GBS Location	☐ Global Business Services Barcelona ☐ Global Business Services Costa Rica/Brazil ☐ Global Business Services Manila ☐ Global Business Services Gdansk ☐ Global Business Services India ☒ Global Business Services Dalian ☐ Global Business Services Germany
Region/ Country	☐ Global ☒ Specific Country: Kazakhstan, Kyrgyzstan (CH), Mongolia (CH), Uzbekistan (CH)
Relevance for R&D QMS	☐ Affected ☐ Interface ☒ N/A

Version:	Version 4.0
Document Author(s):	Ziyao Wu
Document Approver(s):	CQH: Roza Kadyrbayeva PTC Team Leader/SME: Jinghua Yin
Training Role(s):	GBS_DAL_PTC_CLUSTER 7
Relevant Process and Activities:	PTC

Table of contents

1 Scope and Framework 5
1.1 Scope 5
1.2 Framework 5
2 Abbreviations 5
3 Purpose & Set-Up 5
3.1 Purpose 5
3.2 General guidance 5
3.3 Roles and responsibilities 6
4 Specific requirements regarding PTC handling 8
4.1 Country Specific Requirements listed by different topics 8
5 Internal References 12
6 External References 12
History of changes 13
7 Annex 14
Annex 1 14
Annex 2 15

1 Scope and Framework

1.1 Scope

Bayer Country Quality Units are accountable for a GMP compliant Product Technical Complaint Management within their respective countries. Within this responsibility they are supported by the respective Global Business Services in process steps like complaint initiation, forwarding for investigation to the RQU, and final verification including complaint sample management and reimbursement process.

This SOP defines clear guidance to the Global Business Services regarding all country specific requirements.

1.2 Framework

This SOP is based on principles and requirements outlined in SSC-PTC-SOP-001 “Manage Product Technical Complaint and Suspected Counterfeit Incidents in GBS”.

2 Abbreviations

AE	Adverse Event
CQH	Country Quality Head
CQU	Country Quality Unit
GBS	Global Business Services
OTC products	Over-the-counter products
PTC	Product Technical Complaint
PV	Pharmacovigilance
RQU	Responsible Quality Unit
SSC	Shared Service Center
GBS	Global Business Services

3 Purpose & Set-Up

3.1 Purpose

Country Specific Requirements for Kazakhstan (PH, CH), partly for Kyrgyzstan (CH), Mongolia (CH) and Uzbekistan (CH) are described in this SOP, regarding e.g. Data Privacy, Sample Handling Process, Reimbursement Process, Contacts, escalation rules.

During the processing of all PTCs by Bayer owned Global Business Services all country specific requirements are considered and followed besides the general complaint handling described in the SSC-PTC-SOP-001 “Manage Product Technical Complaint and Suspected Counterfeit Incidents in GBS”.

3.2 General guidance

The employees of Global Business Services are following the SOP during complaint processing in Complaint Database on behalf of the Country Quality Units.

3.3 Roles and responsibilities

PTC GBS team

- manages PTCs and suspected falsification and counterfeit on behalf of the CQUs of the legal entity which introduces product into the market (e.g. Marketing Authorization Holder, Distribution license holder)
- Enters PTCs, suspected falsification and counterfeit i and Usability Issues according to defined timelines, into the global complaint database in English language
- forwards all cases that are not PTCs back to the CQU or applicable function for further processing
- performs the initial intake of complaints after receipt and considering the information provided by the PV in case of an AE and/or a medical device (incl. Medical Device constituent of combination product) is involved
- informs the respective PV about all PTCs with a potential associated AE or LODE or potentially reportable medical device complaints, including the unique complaint database number and all relevant follow-up information (e.g. Batch number)
- informs the CQU about PTCs where local authorities are involved, about all potential falsification and counterfeits and any other cases described in the Country Specific SOPs
- checks completeness and accuracy of information (including the photo or video, if available from the complainant) before forwarding the cases to the RQU
- Initiates first contacts with the complainant within first 5 days of receipt of the complaint information to obtain follow-up information asks CQU for any support contacting the complainant if not possible/allowed by GBS (e.g. data privacy, non-hosted language)
- ensures translation of non-hosted languages
- forwards all cases to the respective RQU for further investigation and final assessment
- checks if a complaint sample is available and starts the process to retrieve the sample, documenting these efforts including the number of attempts requesting sample in detail in complaint database
- reviews the case for plausibility and closes the assessed complaint in complaint database
- support the process for reimbursement management
- responds to the complainant, for PTC+AEs in liaison with the PVCH and documents the response in the global complaint database or other cross-referenced system in cooperation with the CQU
- notifies the legal manufacturer of a device and where necessary, the manufacturer's authorized representative and the importer, if applicable.in case of any discussion or doubts contacts the CQH as the first line support

Country Quality Head (CQH) / Country Quality Unit (CQU)	- ensures the appropriate handling of PTCs, and suspected falsified and counterfeit incidents, reported in the respective country including the timely execution of the related activities, particularly for the entry of the cases into complaint database, forwarding them and for responding to the complainant - responds to the complainant, for PTC+AEs in liaison with the PVCH and documents the response in the global complaint database or other cross-referenced system in corporation with the Global Business Services - fulfills all obligations, e.g. PTC related reporting requirements defined by legislations or regulations - oversees and monitors the whole PTC process for products on market of their legal entity in case of delegation to GBS by controlling appropriate Key Performance Indicators according to GSOP 1372 “Perform Country Quality Management Review”.

4 Specific requirements regarding PTC handling

4.1 Country Specific Requirements listed by different topics

Description	Assigned Roles & Document Reference
4.1.1 General Information In Kazakhstan the company operates under legal entity “Bayer KAZ” LLP. The main office is located in Almaty. The Kazakhstan division of Bayer represents the interests relating to PTC handling in within Consumer Health divisions in Kyrgyzstan, Mongolia and Uzbekistan. CQH KZ contacts with responsible persons of distributors, with whom Bayer has agreements. Complaints from Central Asia counties are indicated with ISO code of county and forwarded to GBS by CQH KZ.	
4.1.2 Contact list CQH KZ/CQU – Roza Kadyrbayeva*roza.kadyrbayeva@bayer.com* CQH deputy/Responsible Person–Tatyana Gunko: *tatyana.gunko@bayer.com* **Remark:** Current name and e-mail address of the CQH and the CQH deputy are found on the QINT SharePoint: *Country Quality List*	
4.1.3 Escalation Rules The CQH and the CQH deputy should be notified via e-mail (also via generic CQU address if applicable) about any complaint case referring to at least one of the following situations: - All cases with potential risk classification High or Medium* - Suspected Counterfeit Cases - Any cases involving Health Authorities - Confirmed cases with final risk classification High or Medium *potentially life-threatening or could cause a serious risk to health Above Escalation Rules are applicable for complaint cases from Kyrgyzstan (CH), Mongolia (CH) and Uzbekistan (CH). **Remark:** Current name and e-mail address of the CQH and the CQH deputy are found on the QINT SharePoint: *Country Quality List*	GBS
4.1.4 Pharmacovigilance cases CQH KZ is responsible for communication with local Pharmacovigilance department. If a complaint case is related to any type of Adverse Event, the Pharmacovigilance department has to be informed via e-mail by CQH KZ. Contact data of local Pharmacovigilance department is provided for an information: Pharmacovigilance employee: Daniyar Amutov *daniyar.amutov@bayer.com* PV general mailbox: *pv.centralasia@bayer.com*	GBS CQU

Description	Assigned Roles & Document Reference
4.1.5 Product Samples The sample handling process described below is applicable for complainants from the Kazakhstan market and Kyrgyzstan, Mongolia and Uzbekistan markets as well. In case a complaint sample is available and requested for investigation by RQU. GBS informs the CQH KZ that the particular sample must be retrieved. CQH KZ makes 3 attempts of a sample requesting, documents them and, in case of absence of sample, provides GBS with the reason. Then GBS specifies the result of requesting in "Immediate Actions" in Complaint Database. The complaint sample could be sent by CQH KZ if the following mandatory requirements are met: - Product registered in the country; - Original Bayer invoice is available; - Local HA permission is provided. If the delivered product was cleared at WTO (World Trade Organization) rates, then complaint samples cannot be exported and provided for an investigation due to legal restrictions.	GBS
4.1.6 Statement letter **Response Letter after closing:** CQH KZ is responsible for providing the response to the complainant. Regardless of whether a response was requested by the complainant, GBS notifies CQH KZ about case closure via e-mail for further processing. The notification contains the Complaint Database number and the result of final RQU conclusion without any copies out of the complaint database. Recommended template of the notification is available in Annex 2. The response letter is prepared by CQH KZ according to local legislation requirements.	GBS
4.1.7 RQU Contact list For CH products registration status in the respective country as well as Manufacturing Site are available via SYNAPS: go/synaps. List with the respective RQU contact names are provided by the Divisional Quality Assurance function and available on the SharePoint: PH: *PH RQU responsible list_HJ.xlsx* CH: *IQMS_MASTER LIST COMPLAINT RESPONSIBILITIES.xlsx*	GBS
4.1.8 List of Local Opportunities Products Local Opportunities Product is provided below. Consumer Health Product:	

Description	Assigned Roles & Document Reference

Product name	Theraflex Chondrocream
Manufacturing site	AO “Nizhpharm”, Nizhny Novgorod, Russia (Complaint Database name “STADA CIS LLC, Nizhny Novgorod, Russia”)
Contract manufacturer	Yes
Lead investigation unit	CQU RU (LQR in Complaint Database)

4.1.9 Data Privacy Requirements

Law of the Republic of Kazakhstan dated May 21, 2013 "On Personal Data and their Protection" No. 94-V regulates activities related to the processing of a private data in Kazakhstan.

Data Privacy Requirements are applicable for all information about individuals (name, address, phone number, e-mail), i.e. it is not allowed to transfer them to GBS.

Based on the foregoing complaints are managed only after anonymization.

Anonymization is performed via assigning Customer ID to each incoming complaint from individuals by CQH KZ.

Customer ID is mentioned into Comments field of Complaint Database by GBS.

The awareness date for Complaint starts when CQH KZ open and read a complainant letter. The deadline for an entering data into Complaint Database includes data anonymization activities. Timelines specified for complaint entering into Complaint Database for different initial risk classification are shared between CQH KZ and GBS.

After opening complainant letter CQH KZ conducts primarily evaluation and determines the urgency of PTC (urgent PTC is considered in case of risk classification High and Medium).

Depending on the urgency of Complaint timelines for anonymization data and data entering are as follows:

Initial Risk Classification	Data anonymization by CQH KZ	Data Entry by GBS team	Total timelines
High/Medium	12 hours	12 hours	1 day
Medium/Low	max. 4 days	min. 1 day	5 days

***** Cases requires immediate escalation within 24 hours, e.g., for serious public health threats, potentially life-threatening cases, cases potentially requiring a FAR.

Remark:

If a complainant provided all mandatory data, CQH KZ forwards the PTC to GBS as soon as possible, and no later than 24 hours before timeline end for risk classification Medium/Low and 12 hours for risk classification High/Medium*.

If not all data was provided by complainant - with the first message.

Description	Assigned Roles & Document Reference
CQH KZ includes date of first awareness of a PTC in the message subject sent to GBS. Additionally, in case of urgency, remark "Urgent" is also added to the message subject to ensure that PTC can be recognized and prioritized by GBS.	
4.1.10 Gathering additional information (including obtaining translation) In case when the CQU receives a complaint firstly by a phone, then Product Complaint Form (see Annex 1) is used to document received information. The CQU sends this form to the GBS via e-mail as soon as possible, because timeline starts when phone complaint is received by the CQU. All complaints coming to GBS are managed in Russian. Since Russian language is a hosted language in GBS Dalian complaint e-mails in Russian are managed in GBS without translation. Such languages as Kazakh, Kyrgyz and Uzbek are not hosted in GBS Dalian, however, all complaints from those counties go through CQH KZ and they are previously translated into Russian and English (complaints from Mongolia). Kazakhstan and Central Asia countries have on average less than 100 complaints per year per country. Therefore, countries are classified as micro language and, in case PTC officer with Russian is not available, GBS informs CQH KZ about the absence of that person and asks to provide complaints already in English. This is the responsibility of CQH KZ to translate complaints to English before forwarding to GBS. The contact with the complainant to gather missing information regarding the complaint is performed by CQH KZ, who stores the consumer data. Collecting missing information is performed within timelines determined in chapter 4.1.9.	GBS CQU
4.1.11 Reimbursement and Replacement The reimbursement process described below is applicable for complainants from the Kazakhstan market and Kyrgyzstan, Mongolia, and Uzbekistan markets as well. Reimbursement for the product is possible only for confirmed PTC. GBS notifies CQH KZ about case closure via e-mail and then CQH KZ process with a reimbursement to complainant. CQH KZ escalates the result of final RQU conclusion to relevant responsible department and controls implementation. **Remarks:** For products with unconfirmed defects, the Managing Director / Head of the relevant division will decide whether to satisfy a consumer complaint, for example, in cases involving restrictive measures by authorized state authorities on removing samples of medicinal products or medical devices to the manufacturing plant, or in other cases determined by a corresponding memo (MR).	GBS
4.1.12 Mandatory Spot Checks for Translations For all countries where the complaints are sent out for translation to the BS translation office once a year mandatory spot checks must be performed. 5% of all complaint numbers per year should by checked by native speaker (based on random selection), e.g. CQU. Important is to check the “original income text” with “translated text” provided by BS translation office.	GBS

Description	Assigned Roles & Document Reference

The GBS is the owner of the process and start this action. The GBS leads the process, picks the cases and provides report to the CQU. The CQU checks the translation and indicates the deviations.

Acceptance Criteria:

- No Major translation deviations
- Total number of Minor translation deviations is less than 5%.

Deviations in the translation can be described as Minor or Major.

- Minor translation deviations are deviations where a single word or short section of a sentence has been insufficiently translated, but the essence or meaning of the original message is still captured.
- Major translation deviations are deviations where a single word or short section has been incorrectly translated (for example by the introduction of a new word or exclusion of a word from the original complaint in the translated version) which results in an incorrect essence or meaning in the translation of the original message.

In case of a major translation deviation and exceeding the 5% minor cases, the GBS will be informed promptly to open a deviation in Complaint Database and to ensure appropriate CAPAs.

In addition, the translation office needs to be informed.

4.1.13 Exceptions and special cases

n.a.

4.1.14 Others

n.a.

5 Internal References

- SSC-PTC-SOP-001 “Manage Product Technical Complaints and Suspected Counterfeit Incidents in GBS”

6 External References

- N/A

History of changes

Version	Significant changes with respect to previous version	Effective date
1.0	New document	2020-06-03
2.0	# Document is updated according to SSC-PTC-BP-002 “Country specific SOP template”: Chapter 3.3. GBS responsibilities updated Chapter 4.1.6 Escalation rules updated New chapter 4.1.12 Mandatory Spot Checks for Translation Annex 1 (Product Complaint Form) added # Format of “Applicability Sheet” was updated and renamed to “Distribution Sheet” # Shared Service Center (SSC) is changed to Global Business Services (GBS) # Change of document numbering in header from SSC-SOP-KZ-006 to SSC-PTC-SOP-KZ-006 # CQH responsibility partly for Uzbekistan and Mongolia was specified according to country organizational changes (chapters 4.1.1 and 4.1.3 updated) # CQH responsibility for Tajikistan and Turkmenistan was deleted # Annex 2 Template of notification is added.	2022-11-01
3.0	#4.1.3, 4.1.1 Product division for Mongolia, Kyrgyzstan and Uzbekistan are specified. # # Chapter 1.2, 3.1, 5 Document name updated according to changes.	2024-01-17
4.0	# Update Distribution Sheet # Update through all the documents reflecting Global SOP-115 version 14.0 updates. # Replace “Dev@Com” with “Complaint Database” # Replace “Risk Category” to “Risk classification” # Replace session 3 roles and responsibility to align with GSOP 115, session 4.0, PTC GBS Team, Country Quality Head (CQH) / Country Quality Unit (CQU) # Updated CQH/CQU email address list in session 4.1.2 # Updated 4.1.3 # Updated 4.1.5 # Updated 4.1.7 # Updated 4.1.9 # Updated 4.1.11	See Cover page

7 Annex

Annex 1

Product Complaint Form

Complaint created (date)……
Complaint received (date) ……

Product information:	
Product name	
Batch / lot number	
Dosage form *(cream, tablet, capsule, etc.)*	
Package type/size	
Number of packages	
Sample available?*	Yes/No
*Sample available = please keep for further potential shipment	

Complaint information:	
Complaint description (defect description, is it suspected counterfeit case, etc.)	
Adverse event reported?	Yes/No
Does the complainant expect a response from Bayer?**	
**By requesting a response, the Complainant agrees to his/hers contact data being processed by Bayer for the purpose of providing the answer to the submitted complaint *(the exact sounding to be aligned with legal)*	

Complainants' contact information attention: in the countries with special Data Privacy regulations to be replaced by the complainant code number (to be given by CQU)	
Name and surname	
E-mail address	
Telephone	
Home address	

Sender (if other than Complainant, e.g. a pharmacy)	
Senders' Name (Legal entity)	
Address	
E-Mail address	
Telephone number	

Any additional information	

Annex 2

Template of the notification



Annex_2.docx

Task: Content Approval Verdict: Approve changes & release Approval to be made Effective	Roza Kadyrbayeva, (roza.kadyrbayeva@bayer.com) Approver - Content 08-May-2025 08:42:47 GMT+0000

Task: Final Approval Verdict: Approve changes & release Final Approval to be made Effective	Jinghua Yin, (jinghua.yin@bayer.com) Approver 08-May-2025 09:00:38 GMT+0000